BIRUK AREGU

Active DoD Secret Clearance | U.S. Citizen
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LinkedIn • GitHub • Website

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security-focused IT professional with an active DoD Secret Clearance and a B.S. in Computer and Information Sciences (Summa Cum Laude). CompTIA Security+ (DoD 8570 IAT Level II) and AWS Solutions Architect certified, with hands-on strength in SIEM monitoring, log analysis, and incident response developed through enterprise support of 1,500+ users in regulated environments and self-directed security projects spanning SOC triage, honeypot threat intelligence, and phishing simulation. Skilled across Splunk, Wireshark, Nmap, Active Directory, and ServiceNow, with cloud expertise in AWS, Azure, and GCP. Seeking to apply threat detection, analysis, and incident response skills within a Security Operations Center supporting mission-critical defense IT.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations & SIEM: Splunk, Wireshark, Nmap, Nessus, IDS/IPS, Firewalls, Incident Response, Threat Hunting, Log Analysis, Root Cause Analysis, MITRE ATT&CK, Sigma Rules, IOC Hunting, NIST 800-61

Operating Systems: Windows, Linux, macOS

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, GCP

Identity & Access (IAM): Active Directory, Azure AD

Networking: TCP/IP, VPN, DNS, DHCP, LAN/WAN, Switches, Routers, OSI Model, SNMP, Firewall ACLs, Configuration Backups, Patching, Vulnerability Remediation

Endpoint & Service Management: ServiceNow, Jira, Zendesk, Remote Desktop, MECM/SCCM, Intune, Tanium, Software Packaging, MS Office, User Training

Systems Analysis & Automation: Business Requirements, Feasibility, Cost-Effectiveness, Compliance, Testability, Regression Testing, Release Management, UiPath, Power Automate, COTS/GOTS, Audit Readiness, Internal Controls

Testing & QA: UAT, SDLC, STLC, Agile, Defect Tracking, Test Scripts

Databases: SQL, MySQL, Oracle, MongoDB

Programming & Scripting: Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, SQL, Bash Scripting

Core Competencies: Attention to Detail, Customer Service, Oral Communication, Problem Solving

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+ (2025) — DoD 8570 IAT Level II
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (2026)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Specialist (Tier II)
June 2026 – Present

Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) | Philadelphia, PA

- **Incident Response:** Triage and resolve 130 hardware, VDI, and VPN incidents per month for DLA users in a classified (Secret) environment, documenting root cause, escalation, and resolution in ServiceNow.
- **Endpoint Security & Compliance:** Enforce DoD endpoint-security and STIG policies and track user, device, and system compliance across the DLA workstation fleet, supporting audit readiness for security inspections.
- **System Hardening & Deployment:** Reimage and deploy workstations via MECM/SCCM and Intune using standardized, policy-compliant builds, and remediate permission and credential issues on Windows and Linux.
- **Documentation:** Author SOPs and knowledge-based articles for standard support and security procedures, reducing repeat incidents and accelerating new-technician onboarding.

Technology Analyst
November 2024 – November 2025

Independence Blue Cross (IBX) | Philadelphia, PA

- **Service Delivery:** Resolved 15–30 ServiceNow incidents and service requests daily for 1,500+ employees in a regulated healthcare enterprise, applying ITIL best practices to ensure system reliability.
- **Endpoint & Virtualization Support:** Configured and troubleshot Citrix, VMware, mobile, and VDI environments on Windows and macOS to maintain uninterrupted, secure user access.

- **User Enablement:** Diagnosed issues and delivered tailored, customer-focused resolutions with clear documentation; trained and mentored new hires on IT support processes and customer-service best practices.

IT Support Intern January 2022 – May 2022

Harrisburg University of Science and Technology | Philadelphia, PA

- **Process Improvement:** Reduced incident resolution time by 35% through proactive troubleshooting and ServiceNow workflow improvements.
- **First-Contact Resolution:** Resolved 95% of hardware, software, and network issues on first contact across Windows and Linux systems.
- **Identity & Access:** Managed Active Directory accounts, improving account provisioning efficiency by 25%.

SECURITY PROJECTS

- **SOC Triage Console —** Alert triage, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, Sigma rule logic, and IOC hunting aligned to NIST 800-61 incident handling. View Project
- **Honeypot Threat Intelligence System —** Built a honeypot network to detect, analyze, and classify cyber threats and generate intel from live intrusion attempts. View Project
- **Phishing Attack Simulator —** Built an adaptive phishing simulator to train users and measure threat-detection and response behavior. View Project
- **Security Awareness Chatbot —** Built an NLP chatbot that boosted phishing detection in pilot testing. View Project
- **Social Media Cybersecurity Research —** Researched cybercrime activity across social media platforms and delivered comprehensive security recommendations.
- **AWS VPC + Bastion (Terraform) —** Provisioned VPC, bastion, EC2, NAT, S3, SNS, and IAM for CloudTrail-based threat detection using infrastructure-as-code. View Project
- **AI Resume Analyzer —** Built an AI tool that scores resume, finds keywords, rewrites bullets, and exports PDFs. View Project
- **Personal Portfolio Website —** Built a secure, responsive portfolio site with Next.js and React. View Website

EDUCATION

B.S., Computer and Information Sciences Aug 2020 – May 2022

Harrisburg University of Science and Technology | GPA 3.96 — Summa Cum Laude

A.A.S., Computer Information Systems Sep 2018 – Aug 2020

Community College of Philadelphia | GPA 3.71